The Midnight Visitor's Summary

The Midnight Visitor is the story of **Ausable**, a secret agent, and **Fowler**, a young writer. Fowler expects Ausable to be a smart, mysterious and adventurous spy, but Ausable is fat and ordinary-looking. He does not look like a typical secret agent.

When they enter Ausable's hotel room, they find **Max**, another secret agent, waiting with a pistol. Max wants to steal an important report about new missiles. Ausable remains calm and cleverly tells Max that someone has entered his room through the **balcony**. In reality, there is **no balcony**.

Soon, there is a knock at the door. Ausable tells Max that it is the police. Frightened, Max tries to escape through the window by jumping onto the supposed balcony. However, there is no balcony, so Max falls.

The person at the door is actually **Henry, the waiter**, who brings Ausable's drink. Thus, Ausable defeats Max not through physical strength but through his **intelligence, presence of mind and cleverness**.

Main Theme

The story shows that **intelligence and presence of mind are more powerful than physical strength or weapons**.

Character of Ausable

- Intelligent and clever
- Calm in a difficult situation

- Quick-witted
- Excellent at making believable stories
- Uses presence of mind instead of physical force
- Proves that a real secret agent need not look heroic or mysterious

---

2. Textual Questions

Q1. How is Ausable different from other secret agents?

Answer:

Ausable is different from the secret agents described in books and films. He is **fat, ordinary-looking and has an American accent**. He does not look adventurous or mysterious. However, he is highly intelligent, calm and quick-witted. He defeats Max through his cleverness rather than through physical strength.

Q2. Who is Fowler and what is his first authentic thrill of the day?

Answer:

Fowler is a young writer who wants to meet Ausable because he is interested in the exciting life of secret agents. His first authentic thrill of the day comes when he enters Ausable's room and sees **Max standing with a pistol in his hand**.

Q3. How has Max got in?

Answer:

Max has entered Ausable' s room using a **passkey**. He tells Ausable that he did not know about the balcony and that knowing about it might have saved him some trouble.

Q4. How does Ausable say he got in?

Answer:

Ausable says that Max entered through the **balcony**. He invents a story that the balcony belongs to the next apartment and that someone had entered his room through it the previous month. In reality, **there is no balcony**.

---

3. Five Most Important Questions&Answers

Q1. How did Ausable outwit Max?

Answer:

Ausable outwitted Max through his **intelligence and presence of mind**. He invented a false story about a balcony outside his window. When someone knocked at the door, Ausable told Max that the police had arrived. Afraid of being caught, Max tried to escape through the imaginary balcony and fell. Thus, Ausable defeated him without using any weapon.

Q2. How did Ausable convince Max that there was a balcony?

Answer:

Ausable spoke confidently and naturally about the balcony. He said that his room had once been part of a larger apartment and that the balcony of the next apartment extended under his window. He also added that someone had entered through it the previous month. His detailed and believable explanation made Max accept the story without questioning it.

Q3. Why did Max decide to enter Ausable's room?

Answer:

Max entered Ausable's room to steal an **important report about new missiles**. The report was going to be delivered to Ausable that night. Max wanted to take it because he believed it would be safer in his hands than in Ausable's.

Q4. What role did the knocking at the door play in the story?

Answer:

The knocking at the door helped Ausable execute his plan. He falsely told Max that the **police** had arrived. Max became frightened and decided to escape through the supposed balcony. This allowed

Ausable to get rid of Max. The person at the door was actually **Henry, the waiter**, not the police.

Q5. What is the message of "The Midnight Visitor" ?

Answer:

The story teaches that **intelligence, presence of mind and quick thinking are more important than physical appearance or weapons**. Ausable does not look like a typical secret agent, but he successfully handles a dangerous situation through his cleverness. The story also shows that a calm mind can defeat a powerful enemy.

Exam में सबसे important facts

Point	Answer
Author	Robert Arthur
Main character	Ausable
Young writer	Fowler
Villain/another spy	Max
Important object	Report about new missiles
Weapon	Pistol
Hotel	French hotel

Fake escape route	Balcony
Person at the door	Henry, the waiter
Real secret of Ausable	His intelligence and presence of mind
Main theme	Intelligence over physical strength